# Power Platform ALM Recommendations

***Best Practices for Power Platform Application Lifecycle Management***

## *Document Information*

| Version | Issue Date | Changes | Author |
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# 1. Introduction

Power Platform Pipelines are a **native ALM automation feature** designed to simplify and democratize solution deployment across environments (Dev, Test, Prod) for Power Apps, Power Automate solutions

## Key Features of ALM

### For Makers

- Deploy solutions with **just a few clicks** from within the app studio.
- No need to manually export/import solutions.
- No ALM expertise required

### For Admins

- Centrally manage environments and deployment permissions.
- Use **custom hosts** to control access and prevent unauthorized pipeline creation.
- Enable **delegated deployments** with approval workflows

### For Developers

- Extend pipelines using **Power Platform CLI**.
- Integrate with Azure DevOps or GitHub for advanced CI/CD.
- Customize post-deployment actions using **Power Automate**

# 2. Possible ways to Configure ALM in Power platform

**There are three main ways to configure ALM (Application Lifecycle Management) in Power Platform**:

## 2.1. Power Platform Pipelines

**Best for**: Makers and admins who want a **low-code, native ALM experience**.

### Features:

- Built-in deployment automation.

- No need for Azure DevOps or Git.
- Easy setup via Deployment Pipeline Configuration app.
- Supports gated deployments and rollback.
- CLI support for developers.

**Use Case:**

Ideal for organizations looking for **simple, scalable ALM** without external dependencies.

## 2.2 ALM Accelerator for Power Platform

**Best for**: Fusion teams (citizen + pro developers) using **Azure DevOps and Git**.

**Features:**

- Canvas app interface for makers.
- Git-based source control.
- Azure DevOps pipelines for CI/CD.
- Pull request and versioning support.
- Part of the CoE Starter Kit.

**Use Case:**

Great for teams wanting **structured source control and collaboration** with minimal manual effort.

## 2.3 Custom ALM with Azure DevOps

**Best for**: Pro developer teams needing **full control and customization**.

**Features:**

- Full CI/CD pipelines using YAML or classic editors.
- Integration with GitHub, GitLab, or Bitbucket.
- Custom scripts for solution export/import.

- Advanced branching strategies and approvals.

**Use Case:**

Perfect for enterprises with **complex governance, compliance, or integration needs**

### Summary Table

| Feature | Power Platform Pipelines | ALM Accelerator | Custom ALM (Azure DevOps) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Setup Complexity** | Low | Medium | High |
| **Source Control** | No | Git (via Azure DevOps) | Git (any provider) |
| **CI/CD** | Built-in | Azure Pipelines | Fully customizable |
| **Target Users** | Makers, Admins | Makers, Developers | Developers, DevOps Teams |
| **Extensibility** | Moderate (CLI support) | High | Very High |
| **Governance & Compliance** | Basic | Moderate | Advanced |
| | | | |

# 3 Why Power Platform Pipelines Are Ideal

## 3.1 Low Setup Complexity

- Pipelines are **natively integrated** into Power Platform.
- No need for external tools like Azure DevOps or Git.
- Setup can be completed using the **Deployment Pipeline Configuration app** with minimal effort.

## 3.2 User-Friendly for Makers

- Designed for **citizen developers** with little or no ALM experience.
- Makers can deploy solutions directly from the app studio with **guided steps**.
- Reduces dependency on IT or DevOps teams.

## 3.3 Governance & Control

- Admins can define environments, roles, and permissions centrally.
- Supports **gated deployments** and **approvals**, ensuring compliance even in small teams.

## 3.4 Scalable for Growth

- While simple now, pipelines can scale as the organization grows.
- Supports CLI and extensibility for future integration with CI/CD tools like Azure DevOps.

## 3.5 Cost-Effective

- No additional licensing or infrastructure required beyond Power Platform.
- Avoid setting up and maintaining Azure DevOps or Git repositories.

## 3.6 Built-In Monitoring & Recovery

- Deployment history, logs, and rollback options are available out-of-the-box.
- Ensure reliability and traceability without custom tooling.

## 3.7 Strategic Fit

Power Platform Pipelines offer a **balanced approach**, simple enough for a small team, yet powerful enough to support future growth. It aligns perfectly with the organization's current needs and resource availability.